



Associations Between Prenatal Cannabis Use and Depression

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1 Introduction

Pregnancy is a developmental period often characterized by increased rates of depression.

Prenatal cannabis use is also increasing due to potential therapeutic effects (for nausea, sleep, pain, etc).

Unfortunately, cannabis use has been linked to adverse psychological outcomes, including depression, among adults; but studies have not tested associations between cannabis and depression among pregnant adults.

This study tested whether depression symptoms differ as a function of cannabis use during pregnancy.

2 Hypothesis

Women who use cannabis during pregnancy will report more depression symptoms than pregnant women who do not use cannabis.

3 Method



Participants

$N = 210$ pregnant adults (all assigned female at birth) were recruited from across the United States

- Average age 29y
- 38% Black
- 4% Hispanic
- 1% Asian
- 2% Native American/Alaska Native
- 2% Multiracial
- 53% White
- 58% in second trimester

Design & Procedure

Cross-sectional online survey

Measures

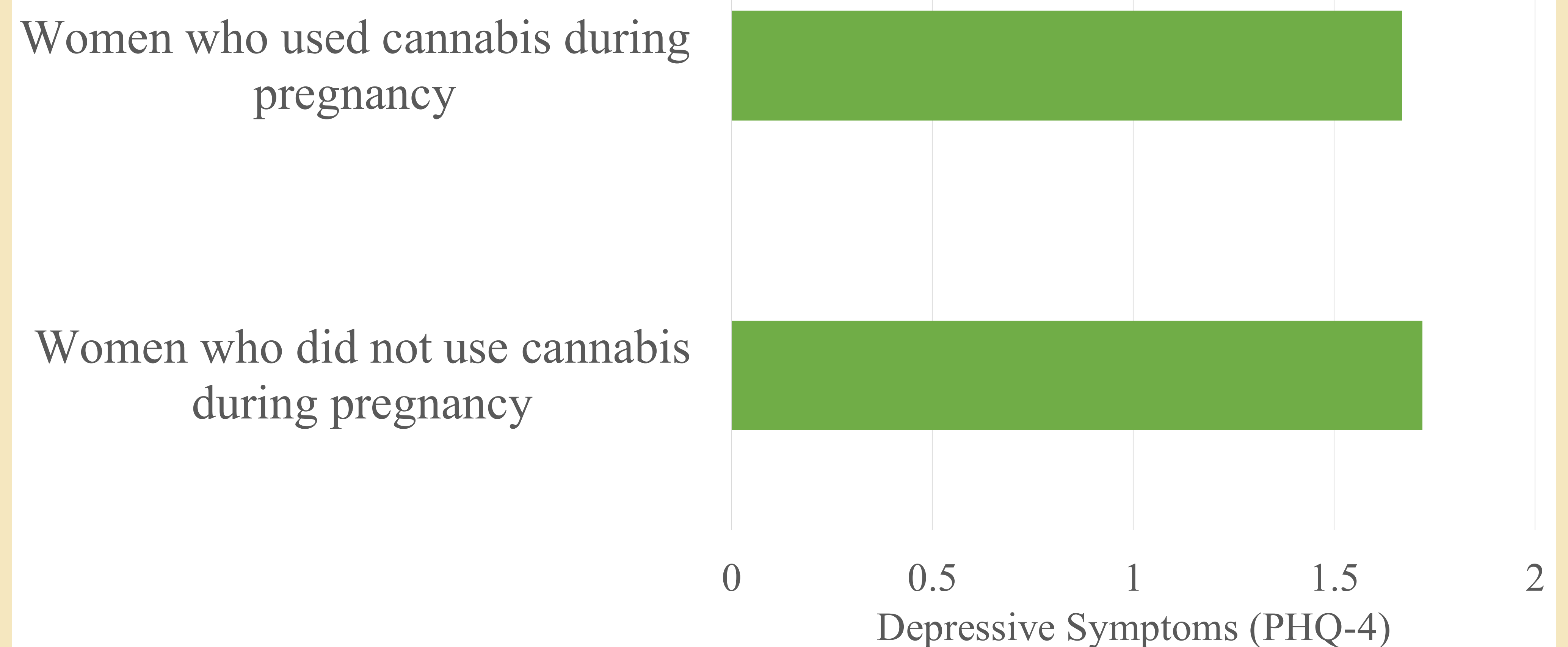
- Demographics
- Patient Health Questionnaire-4
- The Daily session Frequency, Age of onset, and Quantity of Cannabis use Questionnaire

4 Results

Of 210 participants, 185 used cannabis during pregnancy and 25 did not.

Depression symptoms were similar among those who did ($M=1.67$, $SD=1.66$) and did not ($M=1.72$, $SD=1.77$) use cannabis during pregnancy [$t(208) = 0.139$, $p = .445$].

Depression Symptoms and Cannabis Use Among Pregnant Women



5 Conclusions

Pregnant women with a recent history of cannabis use reported relatively moderate symptoms of depression, regardless of current cannabis use.

Future studies may compare rates of depression among pregnant women with and without a lifetime history of cannabis use to better isolate associations. Alternatively, pregnant adults with and without depression may report different motives for cannabis use.

We encourage research examining these associations in larger, more diverse samples.

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